

Frank Nowicki

Linux Systems Administrator · Cloud Infrastructure & Data Center Operations

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SUMMARY

Hands-on Linux systems administrator with 20+ years running CentOS, Ubuntu, SUSE, and Solaris in production for automotive, financial-services, and business-process-outsourcing customers. Habitually the escalation point for the problems nobody else could reproduce — root-cause work that took one enterprise estate from roughly 300 monthly incidents to 80 and turned a failure-prone environment into a monitored, standardized platform. Track record of zero-data-loss migrations, data center deployments, scale-out storage administration, Cisco routing and switching, and Bash/Python automation that removes manual effort permanently. Most recently designed and operated a globally distributed serverless platform end to end. AWS Certified Solutions Architect and SysOps Administrator; Red Hat administration and security training.

CORE SKILLS

Linux Administration	CentOS, RHEL, Ubuntu, SUSE, Solaris 8–11 — patching and lifecycle management, kernel tuning, systemd services, LVM and filesystem management, SELinux policy, firewall configuration, performance tuning and capacity analysis
Troubleshooting & Escalation	Systems-level analysis of non-routine performance, stability, and security issues; root-cause investigation and permanent remediation; Level 2/3 escalation ownership; incident-volume reduction
Scripting & Automation	Bash, Python (Django, Flask, Pandas, asyncio), Perl, PowerShell, C/C++, SQL; Ansible, Puppet, Chef, Jenkins; standardized golden builds, provisioning automation, monitoring and alerting tooling, CI/CD pipelines
Services & Applications	Web, mail, and FTP/SFTP server administration; DNS, NFS; Oracle 12c (certified DBA) and PostgreSQL; key-value data and caching stores; application readiness, dependency analysis, and migration execution
Storage & Virtualization	EMC Isilon scale-out distributed NAS, EMC Celerra, NetApp; backup platform administration and migration; Docker and Kubernetes; OpenStack; virtualized test environments
Networking & Security	Cisco routing and switching (OSPF, EIGRP, STP), CCENT certified; DNS, NFS, secure FTP; firewall configuration and service hardening; load balancing and high-availability patterns (AWS Elastic Load Balancing, Route 53)
Cloud	AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, IAM, Backup) — Solutions Architect & SysOps Administrator certified; Cloudflare Workers, KV, and Pages; Azure
Documentation & Standards	Configuration and operational standards, runbooks and build documentation, release coordination across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources

EXPERIENCE

Independent Cloud & Platform Developer — Self-Employed

2024 – Present · Remote

- Designed and operate a production serverless backend on Cloudflare's global edge network — authenticated endpoints, scheduled sweep jobs, and KV-backed state — including a server-side dead-man's-switch that delivers alerts when the user's device is powered off, verified end to end in unattended production testing.
- Diagnosed a silent multi-day production outage from user-visible symptoms alone, tracing a degraded fallback path back to a credential that had been removed from configuration and never re-provisioned as a secret; built a zero-cost authentication probe so the same failure mode can be detected in seconds rather than days.
- Re-architected a device-dependent notification path into a redundant server-side one using Twilio for carrier-grade SMS and Cloudflare Email Sending for international delivery, eliminating a single point of failure in the alerting chain.
- Automated release delivery through the Google Play Developer API and Gradle Play Publisher using Workload Identity Federation, satisfying a security policy that prohibits long-lived service-account keys; maintained five independent signing and release pipelines with distinct review and compliance requirements.

Career Break — Family Caregiving & Professional Development

2017 – 2023

- Full-time caregiver for a family member while maintaining and deepening technical skills through structured certification study.
- Earned **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** and **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018), and **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA).
- Completed Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration and security training — SELinux policy, firewall configuration, service hardening, monitoring, and performance tuning — alongside Docker, Kubernetes, Puppet, and Python automation coursework.

Senior Unix/Linux System Administrator — SourceHOV

Oct 2011 – Jan 2017 · Troy, MI

- Served as senior technical escalation point for Linux and Unix issues across a neglected, failure-prone enterprise estate; assessed it end to end, established configuration and operational standards, and rebuilt it into a stable, predictable, monitored platform.
- Reduced monthly incident volume from roughly 300 tickets to 80 through root-cause analysis, proactive remediation, and reprioritization of recurring failure classes — fixing causes rather than reissuing workarounds.
- Designed and implemented monitoring and alerting for mail, web, and FTP services, introducing process-threshold management where none had existed, and surfacing degradation before it reached users.
- Led a migration of 600+ users to a new secure FTP platform and relocated multiple file systems onto EMC Isilon scale-out storage — evaluated dependencies and rollback risk up front, and completed both cutovers with zero data loss.
- Automated user-account provisioning, cutting a manual two-hour process to twenty minutes and removing a standing source of configuration drift.

Unix System Administrator — TEKsystems (Contract)

May 2007 – Jan 2008 · Warren, MI

- Built and maintained a production-parity test environment covering patch levels, security configuration, telecom access, and kernel tuning, so changes were validated against real production behavior before release.
- Coordinated releases across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources, aligning system configuration with application readiness each cycle.

Unix System Administrator — Incentra Solutions / DaimlerChrysler (SHAP)

Apr 2005 – Nov 2006 · Sterling Heights, MI

- Deployed and configured network-attached storage appliances backing up plant servers across multiple Chrysler facilities — on-site hardware and system build-out, then ongoing administration of Linux-based GuardianOS, DNS, and NFS.
- Led migration of Unix and Windows clients from NetBackup to NetVault across Solaris 2.6–9 environments, evaluating per-client dependencies and sequencing cutovers around production windows.

Unix System Administrator — LaSalle Bank (Contract)

Jun 2004 – Jan 2005 · Troy, MI

- Wrote Bash automation for EMC Celerra volume creation and rsync-based replication; built mirrored volumes with Solstice DiskSuite and standardized Solaris 8 post-installation through JumpStart imaging for repeatable builds.

Systems Engineer — Technical Solutions, LLC

Jun 1997 – Jun 2003 · Troy, MI

- Pre- and post-sales engineering: technical presentations, proofs of concept, client product integration, and Level 2/3 escalation support — translating between customer requirements and system implementation.

WHAT COLLEAGUES SAY

"Frank was the senior Unix admin when I worked with him at SourceHOV. He expertly fixed a neglected Unix environment, proactively configured systems so they no longer failed, and added value by putting monitoring in place and setting standards. Under his leadership it became a stable, predictable platform. He is one of the very best Unix admins I have worked with and would be a benefit to any company that hires him."

— Steve Allison, Backup and Recovery Engineer · worked with Frank at SourceHOV

"Frank is an awesome System Administrator. Professional. Effective. Solution-oriented. Looking forward to working with Frank again soon."

— Kuldip Bhatt, Senior Technology & CRM Operations Leader

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** (2018) · **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018)
- **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA) — Global Institute of Information Technology
- **Cisco Certified Entry Networking Technician (CCENT)** — Cisco Networking Academy
- **Associate of Applied Science, Information Technology** — Macomb Community College
- **Unix/C Certificate Program** — Marygrove College: Unix system and network administration, shell scripting, C programming